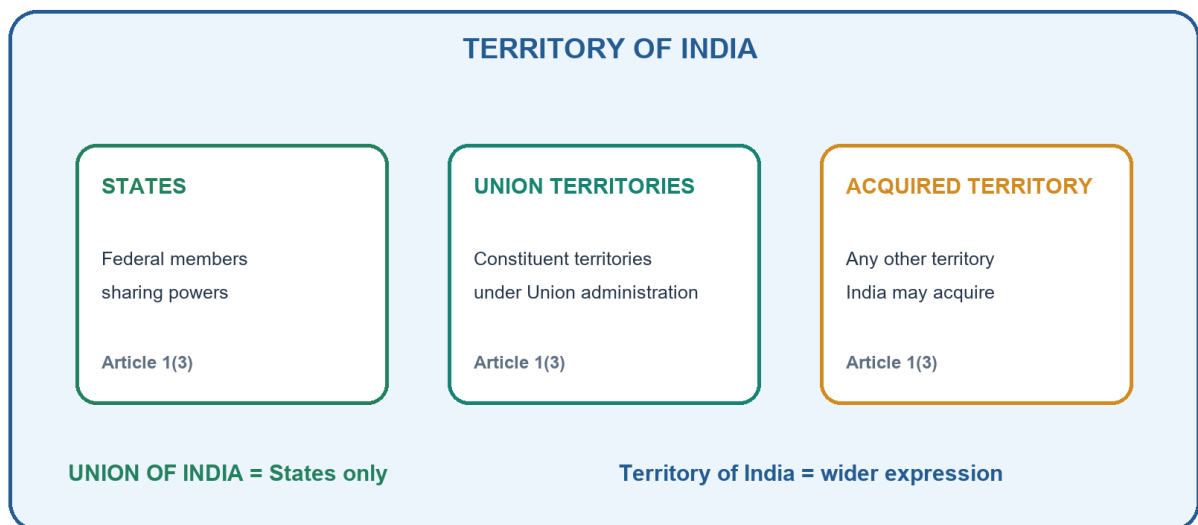


SOLVED PRACTICE WORKBOOK

UPSC complete learning session | Foundation to advanced | Concepts, evidence, practice and answer writing

POLITY 05 | UNION AND TERRITORY

The territorial architecture of India



Original deterministic study visual; labels are explanatory, not textual quotations.

Source order: repository knowledge -> official current linkage -> clearly marked analysis. No fabricated PYQs or statistics.

Solved topic-specific MCQs

PYQ 1. Prelims 2025, GS Paper I, Question 52 - verbatim-verified with official UPSC key

Consider the following pairs:

State	Description
I. Arunachal Pradesh	The capital is named after a fort, and the State has two National Parks
II. Nagaland	The State came into existence on the basis of a Constitutional Amendment Act
III. Tripura	Initially a Part 'C' State, it became a centrally administered territory with the reorganization of States in 1956 and later attained the status of a full-fledged State

How many of the above pairs are correctly matched?

(a) Only one (b) Only two (c) All the three (d) None

Official answer: (c) All the three.

- Pair I is correct: Itanagar is named after Ita Fort, and Arunachal Pradesh has Namdapha and Mouling National Parks.
- Pair II is accepted as correct by the official UPSC key. Nagaland's Statehood settlement combined the State of Nagaland Act, 1962 with the Constitution (Thirteenth Amendment) Act, 1962, which inserted Article 371A.
- Pair III is correct: Tripura was a Part C unit, became a UT in the 1956 arrangement and attained Statehood in 1972.

Why this earns marks: it follows the official key and explains why the ordinary Statehood Act and the accompanying constitutional amendment are not mutually exclusive.

PYQ 2. Mains 2018, GS Paper I, Question 12 - audited routing-ledger neutral rendering

Question: Discuss whether the formation of new States in recent times has been beneficial for India's economy. (15 marks, 250 words)

Model solution. [CLAIM] State creation changes the scale and incentives of government, but economic gains depend on capacity and transition quality rather than size alone. [EVIDENCE] Chhattisgarh brought government closer to a large tribal-mineral region; Uttarakhand could focus on mountain infrastructure and tourism; Jharkhand gained a distinct budgetary platform; Telangana obtained a separate policy arena in 2014. [ANALYSIS] These changes can improve problem recognition, policy focus and accountability. [QUALIFICATION] Statehood did not automatically cure Jharkhand's institutional instability; Uttarakhand faces ecological costs; Andhra-Telangana division generated capital, asset, institution and river-water disputes. New capitals and cadres impose fixed costs, while weak revenue capacity can deepen grant dependence. [VERDICT] New States are economically beneficial when they correct administrative neglect and are backed by viable finances, accountable institutions and negotiated asset division. **Why this earns marks:** it answers the economic test, uses four named examples, links evidence to mechanisms and qualifies every gain.

PYQ 3. Mains 2022, GS Paper I, Question 11 - audited routing-ledger neutral rendering

Question: The political and administrative reorganisation of States and territories has been a continuous process since the mid-nineteenth century. Discuss with examples. (15 marks, 250 words)

Model solution. [CLAIM] India's map is a continuing process shaped by colonial administration, integration, linguistic accommodation and later identity-development claims. [EVIDENCE] Colonial Bengal's partition and reunification showed the political effects of administrative boundaries. After 1947, accession and merger integrated princely States; Hyderabad, Junagadh and J&K illustrate distinct routes. [EVIDENCE] The 1950 Part A/B/C/D map was transitional. Andhra in 1953 forced language onto the agenda; Fazl Ali's qualified principle produced the 1956 Act and Seventh Amendment. [EVIDENCE] Maharashtra-Gujarat, Nagaland, Haryana, the northeast changes, the three States of 2000, Telangana and the 2019 J&K-Ladakh reorganisation show motives ranging from language and ethnicity to peace, administration, development and security. [VERDICT] Article 3 keeps the map flexible while Article 1 keeps the Union indestructible; legitimacy nevertheless requires consultation, viability and minority safeguards. **Why this earns marks:** it follows chronology, uses named commissions/examples and converts narrative into constitutional

explanation.

PYQ scope note

The 2025 GS-II question on detailed J&K Assembly powers belongs to Polity 25 - Union Territories and is intentionally not duplicated here.

Broad topic-coverage MCQs

Q1. Article 1(1) primarily settles which two issues together?

- A. The country's name and the type of polity
- B. The capital city and the official language
- C. The citizenship rules and the anthem
- D. The emergency powers and amendment process

Answer: A. Article 1(1) gives both the name - India, that is Bharat - and the formula 'Union of States'.

Q2. Which statement best captures the difference between the Union of India and the Territory of India?

- A. The Union of India includes only Parliament, while the Territory of India includes Parliament and the States
- B. The Union of India refers to the States as federal members, while the Territory of India also includes Union Territories and acquired territories
- C. The Union of India means the Union executive, while the Territory of India means the Union judiciary
- D. The two expressions are exact constitutional synonyms

Answer: B. This distinction flows directly from Article 1 and is one of the most examinable definitions in the chapter.

Q3. Article 2 is conceptually different from Article 3 because Article 2 deals with

- A. renaming existing States
- B. creation of legislative councils in States
- C. admission into the Union or establishment of new States not already part of the existing Union
- D. cession of Indian territory to a foreign State

Answer: C. Article 3 handles internal reorganisation of existing units; Article 2 is the external-admission clause.

Q4. Which one of the following is NOT one of the express Article 3 operations?

- A. Increasing the area of a State
- B. Altering the name of a State
- C. Altering the boundaries of a State
- D. Ceding accepted Indian territory to a foreign State

Answer: D. Cession is outside Article 3 after Berubari; the other three are expressly listed in clauses (b), (c) and (d).

Q5. Before an Article 3 bill is introduced in Parliament, what is constitutionally necessary?

- A. The prior recommendation of the President
- B. Prior ratification by at least half the States
- C. A joint sitting of both Houses
- D. Approval by the Supreme Court under Article 143

Answer: A. The bill cannot even be introduced without the President's recommendation.

Q6. The legislature of the affected State, when consulted under Article 3, has

- A. a suspensive veto that can be overridden only in a joint sitting
- B. a right to express its views, but no veto over Parliament's final decision
- C. a binding veto unless the Supreme Court permits otherwise
- D. a co-equal decision-making role with Parliament

Answer: B. Article 3 requires consultation, not consent.

Q7. Explanation I to Article 3 matters because it states that

- A. Union Territories are treated as States for all constitutional purposes
- B. States and UTs have identical representation in Rajya Sabha
- C. for clauses (a) to (e), 'State' includes a Union Territory, but not in the proviso requiring legislature-reference
- D. the President may abolish a State by ordinance

Answer: C. This is a close-option trap: inclusion applies to clauses (a)-(e), not fully to the proviso.

Q8. Article 4 keeps reorganisation laws outside Article 368 because such laws are

- A. automatically approved by the Supreme Court
- B. valid only for five years unless renewed
- C. treated as Money Bills
- D. not deemed constitutional amendments for the purposes of Article 368

Answer: D. Article 4(2) expressly says so.

Q9. The First Schedule is constitutionally important because it

- A. lists the States and Union Territories and their territorial extent
- B. contains the amendment procedure
- C. allocates Lok Sabha seats among constituencies
- D. lists the official languages of every State

Answer: A. Territorial and nomenclature changes must be reflected in the First Schedule.

Q10. Which one of the following most accurately states Berubari Union (1960)?

- A. Any change in a State boundary requires prior consent of that State
- B. Cession of accepted Indian territory to a foreign State requires a constitutional amendment
- C. No Indian territory can ever be ceded under the Constitution
- D. Parliament cannot alter a State's name without Article 368

Answer: B. Berubari did not ban cession; it fixed the route - Article 368, not Article 3.

Q11. The Supreme Court's 1969 boundary-settlement ruling is mainly remembered for holding that

- A. every international boundary issue must be referred under Article 143
- B. the Union cannot acquire State property
- C. boundary settlement or ascertainment without cession does not automatically require Article 368
- D. Article 3 and Article 4 are unconstitutional

Answer: C. The case distinguishes boundary implementation from surrender of sovereignty.

Q12. Which constitutional amendment implemented the India-Bangladesh enclave exchange and related territorial adjustments?

- A. The Ninth Constitutional Amendment Act, 1960
- B. The Seventh Constitutional Amendment Act, 1956
- C. The Thirty-Sixth Constitutional Amendment Act, 1975
- D. The 100th Constitutional Amendment Act, 2015

Answer: D. The 100th Amendment gave effect to the Land Boundary Agreement and its protocol.

Q13. Which sequence is correct for the linguistic-reorganisation debate?

- A. Dhar Commission -> JVP Committee -> Andhra State -> Fazl Ali / SRC -> States Reorganisation Act
- B. JVP Committee -> Dhar Commission -> Fazl Ali / SRC -> Andhra State -> Seventh Amendment
- C. Andhra State -> Dhar Commission -> JVP Committee -> Fazl Ali / SRC -> States Reorganisation Act
- D. Fazl Ali / SRC -> Dhar Commission -> JVP Committee -> Andhra State -> States Reorganisation Act

Answer: A. Chronology is often more important than slogans in this topic.

Q14. What was the decisive political trigger for the creation of Andhra State in 1953?

- A. A Presidential reference under Article 143
- B. The prolonged fast and death of Potti Sriramulu
- C. The demand of the JVP Committee
- D. The Ninth Amendment Act

Answer: B. Andhra is the first major linguistic-State milestone.

Q15. The States Reorganisation Act, 1956 together with the Seventh Amendment created

- A. 16 States and 3 Union Territories exactly as originally recommended by the SRC
- B. 28 States and 8 Union Territories
- C. 14 States and 6 Union Territories
- D. 15 States and 5 Union Territories

Answer: C. The government modified the SRC's exact recommendation, but the enacted 1956 outcome was 14 and 6.

Q16. Which one of the following pairs is correctly matched?

- A. Nagaland - Statehood through the Ninth Amendment
- B. Goa - Statehood through the 100th Amendment
- C. Telangana - created by the Seventh Amendment
- D. Sikkim - full Statehood through the 36th Amendment after the brief associate-State experiment

Answer: D. Sikkim's path is constitutionally distinctive and therefore high-yield.

Q17. The present practical count of Union Territories as of 15 Aug 2026 is

- A. 8
- B. 6
- C. 7
- D. 9

Answer: A. The count fell from 9 to 8 after the 2020 DNH-Daman and Diu merger.

Q18. Which sequence of Statehood is correct?

- A. Arunachal Pradesh 1963; Nagaland 1972; Tripura 1987
- B. Nagaland 1963; Tripura 1972; Arunachal Pradesh 1987
- C. Tripura 1963; Arunachal Pradesh 1972; Nagaland 1987
- D. Nagaland, Tripura and Arunachal Pradesh all in 1972

Answer: B. This is the chronology behind Prelims 2025 Q52.

Q19. Which one of the following correctly describes the 1950 map?

- A. Manipur and Tripura were Part B States
- B. Delhi was the sole Part D territory
- C. Part A had 9 units, Part B 9, Part C 10, and Andaman and Nicobar Islands alone formed Part D
- D. Hyderabad was a Part A State

Answer: C. Part C included Delhi, Himachal Pradesh, Manipur and Tripura; Hyderabad was Part B.

Q20. Sikkim's constitutional sequence was

- A. full Statehood in 1974 followed by associate status in 1975
- B. UT status under the Seventh Amendment followed by Article 3 Statehood
- C. associate status under the 36th Amendment followed by Statehood under the 35th

- D. associate-State status through the 35th Amendment in 1974, followed by full Statehood through the 36th Amendment in 1975

Answer: D. Article 2A and the old Tenth Schedule marked the brief associate phase.

Q21. With reference to the India-Bangladesh Land Boundary Agreement, which is correct?

- A. The 100th Amendment implemented an exchange in which India transferred 111 enclaves and received 51
- B. India transferred 51 enclaves and received 111 under the Ninth Amendment alone
- C. The First Schedule did not require amendment
- D. Only West Bengal's territorial entry was affected

Answer: A. Assam, West Bengal, Meghalaya and Tripura were affected.

Q22. As verified on 15 August 2026, the correct J&K position is

- A. Statehood was automatically restored by the 2023 judgment
- B. J&K remains a UT with Legislature; restoration was directed and assured but had not been legally completed
- C. J&K and Ladakh have recombined into a State
- D. Ladakh is a State without Legislature

Answer: B. MHA's current official page continues to describe both as UTs.

Q23. In the 2023 Article 370 judgment, the Supreme Court

- A. held every whole-State-to-UT conversion valid
- B. restored J&K Statehood with immediate effect
- C. upheld carving out Ladakh, treated State views as recommendatory, but did not finally decide the broader whole-State-to-UT issue because of the restoration assurance
- D. held Article 3 inapplicable to Union Territories

Answer: C. This qualified holding is safer than claiming a universal power was conclusively approved.

Q24. Which criterion set is most defensible for evaluating a smaller-State demand?

- A. Population and language alone
- B. Political mobilisation alone
- C. Consent of the parent State alone
- D. Administrative access, fiscal viability, transition costs, resource division, minority safeguards, democratic support and inter-State effects

Answer: D. Statehood is a multi-dimensional governance decision.

Q25. Which one of the following is correctly matched?

- A. United Provinces -> Uttar Pradesh, 1950
- B. Mysore -> Tamil Nadu, 1973
- C. Orissa -> Odisha, 2000
- D. Pondicherry -> Lakshadweep, 2006

Answer: A. Mysore became Karnataka; Orissa became Odisha in 2011; Pondicherry became Puducherry.

Q26. The enacted result of the 1956 settlement was

- A. 16 States and 3 UTs
- B. 14 States and 6 UTs
- C. 28 States and 8 UTs
- D. 9 Part A and 9 Part B States

Answer: B. The Commission's proposed map and the enacted outcome must not be conflated.

Q27. Which statement is correct about Ladakh's current demand?

- A. Statehood was granted by the PIB release of September 2025
- B. Sixth Schedule status automatically followed the 2025 regulations

- C. Official PIB releases recorded Statehood/Sixth-Schedule demands and continuing safeguard dialogue, but no territorial-status change
- D. Ladakh became a State through the 100th Amendment

Answer: C. Demand, dialogue and enacted law are distinct.

Q28. Which statement best explains why Article 3 is often cited as proof of India's strong-Centre bias?

- A. States cannot legislate on the Concurrent List
- B. every State law needs Presidential approval
- C. Rajya Sabha seats are equal across States
- D. Parliament may reorganise States without needing their consent

Answer: D. Article 3 is among the clearest textual examples of centre-weighted federalism.

Remedial MCQs for recurring traps

Q29. A student writes that every change in a State's boundary requires Article 368 because the First Schedule changes. Which correction is most accurate?

- A. Article 4 itself allows First Schedule changes within an Article 3 law, so Article 368 is not normally needed
- B. The First Schedule can never be changed
- C. First Schedule changes are done only by executive notification
- D. Rajya Sabha approval replaces Parliament's ordinary law-making process

Answer: A. This remedial question targets the First-Schedule-amendment trap.

Q30. A candidate uses Article 2 for the creation of Telangana. What is the best correction?

- A. Article 2 applies because Telangana had a separate movement
- B. Telangana was formed from an existing State, so Article 3 was the relevant territorial power
- C. Article 368 alone applies whenever a new State is created
- D. Article 1 alone authorises State creation

Answer: B. Political novelty does not make the territory external to the existing Union.

Q31. A candidate writes the current count as 28 States and 9 UTs. The correction is

- A. 29 States and 8 UTs
- B. 27 States and 9 UTs
- C. 28 States and 8 UTs after the 2020 DNH-DD merger
- D. 28 States and 7 UTs

Answer: C. The State count stayed 28; the UT count fell by one.

Q32. A student confuses Berubari with the Supreme Court's 1969 boundary-settlement principle. Which contrast is right?

- A. Berubari is a State-creation case; the 1969 principle is a renaming rule
- B. Berubari authorises cession by executive order; the 1969 principle bars every boundary agreement
- C. Berubari and the 1969 principle both say Article 3 is enough for cession
- D. Berubari deals with cession of accepted Indian territory; the 1969 principle deals with boundary settlement without such cession

Answer: D. This remedial item repairs the most common case-law mix-up in the topic.

Q33. Which correction best answers the statement 'State consent is mandatory under Article 3'?

- A. Only the State legislature's views are sought; Parliament is not bound by them
- B. Consent is mandatory unless the State is bilingual
- C. Consent is mandatory only for name changes
- D. Consent is mandatory for Article 3 but not for Article 2

Answer: A. This is the central remedial trap of the chapter.

Q34. A candidate writes that the 1956 settlement created 16 States and 3 UTs. The enacted result was

- A. 15 States and 7 UTs
- B. 14 States and 6 UTs
- C. 28 States and 8 UTs
- D. 9 Part A and 9 Part B States

Answer: B. The SRC recommendation and the enacted map were not identical.

Q35. A candidate solves Prelims 2025 Q52 as "only two pairs" by treating the Nagaland statement as false. The correction is

- A. Pair I alone was correct
- B. The question was dropped
- C. The official UPSC key is C, all three pairs; Nagaland's settlement involved both the State of Nagaland Act and the Thirteenth Amendment
- D. Tripura was never a Part C unit

Answer: C. Official-key control overrides an incomplete one-statute elimination.

Q36. Which is the best present-tense statement on J&K as of 15 Aug 2026?

- A. J&K has already regained full Statehood
- B. J&K has no legislature at all
- C. J&K and Ladakh have both become States
- D. J&K remains a Union Territory with a legislature; Statehood restoration has not been officially completed in the accessible source sweep

Answer: D. The package deliberately uses the narrow, source-safe current-status formulation.

Solved Mains practice

Original 10-marker 1: Distinguish the 'Territory of India' from the 'Union of India'. Why does the distinction matter?

Model answer. [CLAIM] The two expressions are related but not identical. [EVIDENCE] Article 1 and standard polity doctrine treat the Union of India as the States taken as federal members, whereas the Territory of India includes the territories of the States, the Union Territories, and such territories as may be acquired. [MECHANISM] This matters because States share constitutionally distributed powers with the Union, while Union Territories are centrally administered units under Articles 239-241 and acquired territories may await internal constitutional placement. [ANALYSIS] The distinction explains why a UT belongs to India without becoming a full federal partner, and why the First Schedule can list both States and UTs while still preserving their unequal constitutional status. [LIMIT] The distinction is structural, not emotional; one should not collapse sovereignty with federal membership. [VERDICT] The Union of India is the federation's membership core; the Territory of India is the wider constitutional space over which Indian sovereignty extends. **Why this earns marks:** it defines both expressions, links them to operative constitutional consequences, and avoids the common synonym trap.

Original 10-marker 2: Distinguish cession of Indian territory from settlement of a boundary dispute.

Model answer. [CLAIM] The Constitution treats cession and boundary settlement differently because only the former parts with accepted sovereign territory. [EVIDENCE] *Berubari Union* (1960) held that ceding accepted Indian territory to a foreign State cannot be done under Article 3 and requires constitutional amendment under Article 368. [MECHANISM] Cession changes the sovereign content of the Constitution's territorial ledger. By contrast, the Supreme Court's later 1969 ruling held that where the issue is ascertainment or implementation of an existing disputed boundary, and not transfer of accepted Indian territory, executive action need not be preceded by Article 368. [ANALYSIS] The test is not whether another country is involved, but whether India is surrendering what it accepts as its own territory. [LIMIT] A boundary-settlement label cannot disguise actual cession. [VERDICT] Cession changes sovereignty and needs amendment; boundary settlement clarifies or implements an existing line and need not. **Why this earns marks:** it identifies the controlling test, uses the safely verified case/principle and converts the distinction into a usable constitutional rule.

Original 15-marker 1: 'India is an indestructible Union of destructible States.' Examine with special reference to Article 3.

Model answer. [CLAIM] The phrase captures the asymmetry built into Indian federalism: the Union's continuity is entrenched, but State boundaries are not. [EVIDENCE] Article 1 names India a Union of States, while Article 3 empowers Parliament to form new States, increase or diminish their area, alter boundaries and alter names. [MECHANISM] An Article 3 bill requires the President's prior recommendation and reference to the affected State legislature for views, but those views are non-binding. Article 4 then keeps the reorganisation law outside Article 368, allowing ordinary-majority change. [ANALYSIS] This makes the Indian federation unlike a compact federation such as the United States, where State consent is structurally stronger. Yet the same flexibility enabled linguistic reorganisation, small-State creation and administrative adaptation without constitutional deadlock. [EVIDENCE] Andhra (1953), the 1956 settlement, and later creations such as Chhattisgarh, Jharkhand and Telangana show the practical utility of this power. [LIMIT] The design can create a democratic-consent deficit when major territorial change proceeds over sharp regional opposition. [VERDICT] India is indestructible because no State can claim a right to continued boundaries or secession; the States are destructible only in the constitutional sense that Parliament may reorganise them, not in the sense of lawless central arbitrariness. **Why this earns marks:** it ties the famous formula to the exact procedural mechanics of Article 3 and balances national flexibility with federal criticism.

Original 15-marker 2: Demands for smaller States should be decided through governance criteria, not identity alone. Discuss.

Model answer. [CLAIM] Identity can establish democratic urgency, but it cannot by itself prove that a new State will govern better. [EVIDENCE] Uttarakhand, Chhattisgarh and Jharkhand were created in 2000 to address distinct regional geographies and developmental claims; Telangana followed in 2014 after sustained regional mobilisation. [ANALYSIS] Smaller units may improve administrative access, policy focus and accountability. [QUALIFICATION] Statehood also creates new capital, cadre and institutional costs; weak revenue bases can deepen grant dependence; water, power, debt and assets can generate inter-State disputes; and a new regional majority may create a new minority. Jharkhand's institutional instability and Andhra-Telangana transition disputes show that Statehood is not a self-executing development policy. [CURRENT EVIDENCE] J&K restoration and Ladakh Statehood demands further require federal, security and minority safeguards; neither demand had changed legal status on 15 Aug 2026. [VERDICT] Parliament should use Article 3 after transparent viability studies, broad consultation and negotiated transition, treating Statehood as a governance instrument rather than a reward for mobilisation. **Why this earns marks:** it uses four named examples, connects each claim to a mechanism, includes present debates and supplies operational decision criteria.

Original 20-marker 1: Linguistic reorganisation strengthened rather than weakened the Indian Union. Critically examine.

Model answer. [CLAIM] Linguistic reorganisation ultimately strengthened the Indian Union because it channelled identity into constitutional politics rather than leaving it outside the system, though not without centralising tensions and new sub-regional claims. [EVIDENCE] The initial hesitation of the Dhar Commission and the JVP Committee reflected a real fear that language-based States might embolden fragmentation. The creation of Andhra in 1953 after Potti Sriramulu's death showed that these demands could not simply be suppressed. [EVIDENCE] The Fazl Ali / States Reorganisation Commission accepted language as a major organising principle but rejected one language-one State and balanced it with viability, unity and welfare. The resulting States Reorganisation Act, 1956 and Seventh Amendment restructured India without dismantling its constitutional framework. [MECHANISM] By aligning administration with language in many cases, the Union reduced alienation, improved representational legitimacy and absorbed regional mobilisation into parliamentary and electoral channels. [ANALYSIS] Later developments - Nagaland, Meghalaya, Mizoram, Goa, Telangana and smaller-State formations in 2000 - show that Article 3 remained an accommodation device, not merely a linguistic tool. [LIMIT] Reorganisation did not end regionalism; it often displaced it into fresh internal claims for smaller units, capitals or autonomous protections. Nor can every present-day demand be justified by language alone. [VERDICT] Linguistic reorganisation did not dissolve the Union; it made the Union governable by recognising identity inside the Constitution. Its success, however, depended on combining language with viability, asymmetry and central constitutional control. **Why this earns marks:** it uses chronology as argument, gives both the fear and the outcome, and converts the 1956 settlement into a broader federalism verdict.

Original 20-marker 2: Does Article 3 reconcile national unity with democratic consent, or does it privilege unity at the expense of federal trust? Critically examine.

Model answer. [CLAIM] Article 3 reconciles unity and democracy only partially: it was designed to privilege the Union's continuity, and democratic consent enters the structure as consultation rather than as a State veto. [EVIDENCE] The President must recommend the bill and refer it to the affected State legislature for views, but Parliament is not bound by those views. Article 4 then keeps the resulting law outside Article 368, reinforcing flexibility. [MECHANISM] This makes Article 3 a nation-preserving safety valve. The Union can respond to secessionary pressures, viability problems, linguistic claims and administrative demands without constitutional paralysis. Andhra, the 1956 settlement, State creation in 2000 and Telangana in 2014 are evidence of this accommodative capacity. [ANALYSIS] Yet the same structure can weaken trust. If an affected State's legislature can only advise and not co-decide, consultation may appear symbolic in politically high-stakes reorganisations. The conversion of a former State into Union Territories in 2019 intensified this anxiety. [EVIDENCE] *State of West Bengal v Union of India* reinforces the strong-Centre reading, while the continuing democratic force of federalism is better captured by the political need for negotiated legitimacy and, in the broader constitutional order, by Bommai's basic-feature floor. [LIMIT] A compact-federation standard is not fully appropriate for India, whose Constitution deliberately rejected a treaty-union model. [VERDICT] Article 3 does not produce symmetrical federal consent; it privileges unity structurally, but can still generate democratic legitimacy when used through negotiation, transparency and accommodation rather than through bare majoritarian power. **Why this earns marks:** it neither romanticises consent nor demonises unity, and it uses the text, history and case law to produce a graded verdict rather than a slogan.